Francois Gerber

Software Engineer — data pipelines, web crawling & LLM extraction

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I build systems that turn the open web into data a business can act on: LLM-powered crawling inside Palantir Foundry processing up to 5,000 company websites a day, dynamic scraping platforms in Python before that, and eight years of .NET full-stack delivery before that. I own the pipeline end to end — extraction quality, reliability at volume, and the data model the business consumes.

EXPERIENCE

Ringier South Africa — Senior .NET Full Stack Developer 2022 – present

Market intelligence and marketplaces data

- Own the crawling and processing platform behind Ringier's marketplaces data: user-configurable pipelines that scrape, process and distribute intelligence in near real time across multiple countries and clients.
- Since 2026, build the LLM-powered crawling system inside Palantir Foundry — identification, extraction and pagination at up to 5,000 company websites a day, on Pipelines, Datasets and Workshop applications.
- Stack: Python, C#, .NET, AWS, Scrapy, Playwright, Puppeteer, Vue, React, MongoDB.

BlueMonday (Pty) Ltd — Software Developer 2015 – 2022

- Delivered business systems for clients and internal tools across the .NET stack: ASP.NET, .NET Core, Web API, WCF, Blazor, plus Angular, Ionic and Node.js on the front end, running on Azure.
- Worked end to end from requirements to support, including integrations with on-site hardware (scales, scanners, label printers, PLCs) for industrial clients.

WW.IT-IQ Training & Solutions — Student Developer 2013 – 2015

- Built programs for coursework and client-commissioned projects while completing the MCSD qualification.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Hades/Olympus — LLM crawler, 2026
Multi-country, multi-client system that identifies, extracts and paginates job listings with an LLM across up to 5,000 sites daily. Python, Palantir Foundry, Jina, ScrapingBee, Scrapy.

Artemis/Apollo — crawling platform, 4 years
Crawler setup and user-generated processing pipelines distributing marketplaces data in near real time. C#, Vue, React, Python, Docker, AWS, MongoDB, Scrapy, Playwright.

iRIS — Refinery Integration Suite — 3 years
Consolidated a precious-metals refinery's standalone tools into one platform, integrated with on-site hardware (scales, scanners, label printers, PLCs, engravers). C#, Angular, Azure, MS SQL.

Operational Intelligence Suite — 2 years, award winner
Real-time sensor monitoring at 12 mining sites, integrated with OSIsoft PI and Wonderware. Won the 2018 Health and Safety Software Award. AngularJS, .NET Web API, MS SQL.

SKILLS

Languages: Python, C#, SQL, Go, TypeScript, JavaScript
Data & crawling: Palantir Foundry (Pipelines, Datasets, Workshop), LLM extraction & prompting, Scrapy, Playwright, Puppeteer, MongoDB, ElasticSearch, Redis
Web: .NET, ASP.NET, Blazor, Angular, Vue, React, Node.js
Platforms: AWS, Azure, Docker, CI/CD, Linux, distributed systems, architecture

EDUCATION

MCSD — WW.IT-IQ Training & Solutions, 2013 – 2015
Microsoft Certified Solutions Developer, Web Applications (HTML5, ASP.NET MVC, Azure) and App Builder

Matric (Grade 12) — High School Lydenburg, 2008 – 2012

CERTIFICATIONS

MCSD Web Applications · MCSD App Builder · Microsoft Certified SQL Specialist · Microsoft Certified Professional · MCTA Networking Fundamentals · MCTS Accessing Data · Microsoft Specialist C# & HTML5/CSS3/JavaScript · Udemy: Go, Python, Prompt Engineering for AI (2025)

INTERESTS

Gaming (Nintendo and PC), reading, gardening, the outdoors.